TOPIC 1 · WHAT TRIAGE IS AND THE FIRST RESPONDER'S ROLE

5 minutes · meaning of triage · why loss size is not urgency · the role boundary

What is it?

Triage comes from hospital emergency rooms: patients are seen in order of danger, not in order of arrival. Cyber triage does the same with incidents. A ₹500 debit that is happening **now** is more urgent than a ₹2 lakh loss from last month, because the first can still be stopped.

A **Community Cyber First Responder** is the first trained person a citizen meets. Their job is to **identify** what is happening, **stabilise** it, **preserve** what matters and **route** the case to the agency that can act — and to stay with it until the hand-over is confirmed.

The First Responder does	The First Responder does not
Listen, ask the six questions, write things down	Investigate who the criminal is
Grade urgency and explain the reason	Scan, trace or hack devices or accounts
Help the citizen stop active loss (bank, 1930, airplane mode)	Take, unlock, reset or wipe the citizen's device
Preserve identifiers and records (Module 5)	Contact, bait or threaten the suspect
Route to police, bank, telecom, platform or IT lead (Module 6)	Promise a freeze, refund or arrest

Real-life case · two citizens, one desk

At a community help desk, Mr Rao arrives first: he lost ₹2 lakh in an investment scam three weeks ago. Five minutes later Sunita arrives: her phone lost signal this morning and ₹18,400 has just been debited. A trained responder apologises to Mr Rao, helps Sunita call her bank and 1930 immediately, and then returns to Mr Rao's case, which still needs a complaint the same day.

Lesson: urgency follows present danger and active loss. Both cases matter; one cannot wait.

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TOPIC 2 · THE STRUCTURED INTAKE

6 minutes · six questions · three different times · fact, account and hypothesis · consent and secrets

What is it?

A **structured intake** is a short interview that collects only what is needed to decide and act. The six questions are asked in a fixed order so nothing important is missed, even when the citizen is upset. Write down the citizen's words; do not tidy them into your own conclusions.

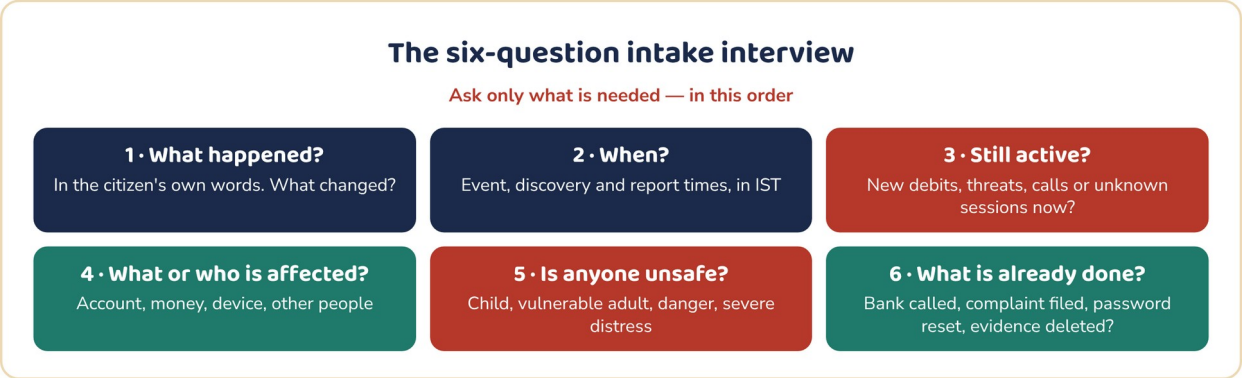


Figure 4.3 · The six-question intake interview

Fact, account or working hypothesis?

Write each in its own column — never mix them

Type	What it is	Example	How to write it
Observed fact	What you saw yourself	Phone shows “No Service” at 09:40	“Observed: …” with time
Citizen's account	What the person tells you	“Someone changed my SIM”	“Citizen states: …” in quotes
Working hypothesis	Your reasoned guess, not yet confirmed	Possible SIM takeover	“Possible …; not confirmed”

Figure 4.4 · Fact, account or working hypothesis?

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Time	Meaning	Why it matters
Event time	When the incident actually happened (e.g. debit at 09:48)	Banks and 1930 work from transaction times
Discovery time	When the citizen noticed it (e.g. 10:05)	Shows how quickly the loss was found
Report time	When it was first reported to anyone (e.g. 10:10)	Matters for bank liability and the golden hour

Consent and secrets

Ask before you write: “May I note down what happened so we can report it?” Record that consent was given.

Offer a safe call-back number and preferred language. Ask whether it is safe to talk where they are.

If a password, OTP or PIN must be entered, the citizen types it on their own device. You never hear, see or record it.

Ask yourself

- Did I let the citizen tell the story before I asked questions?
- Have I recorded event, discovery and report times separately?
- Have I written facts, the citizen's account and my guesses in separate places?

Stop	Save	Report
If loss or threats are active, pause the interview and act first.	Note the six answers with times in IST and the consent given.	Route according to the colour (Topic 4).

Remember

Listen first, ask the six questions in order, and never write a guess as a fact.

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TOPIC 3 · SIX INCIDENT CATEGORIES

6 minutes · standard categories · overlapping incidents · primary and secondary category

What is it?

Every intake is given at least one **category**. Categories decide which agencies are involved and which evidence matters. Real incidents often overlap: a SIM takeover leads to financial fraud; a fake profile leads to harassment. Record a **primary** category (the most harmful) and any **secondary** ones.

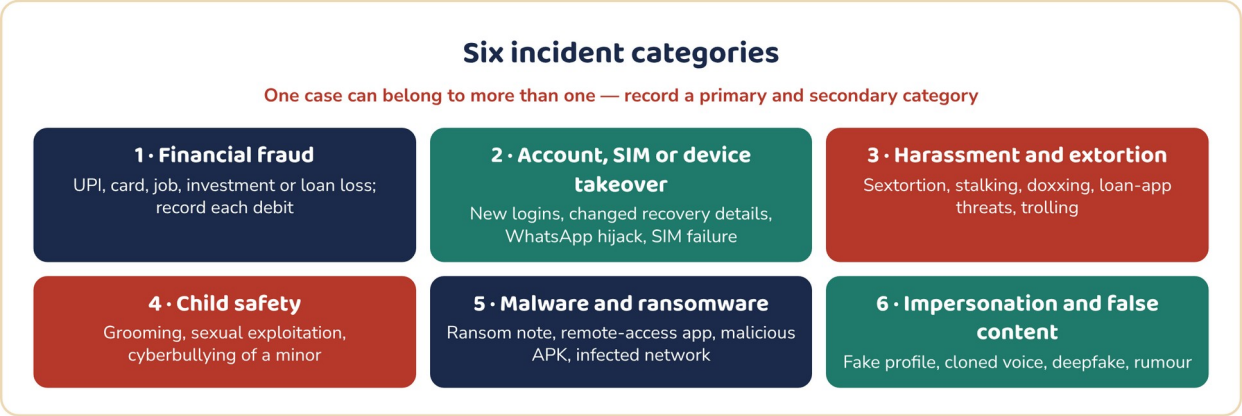


Figure 4.5 · Six incident categories

Incident as described	Primary	Secondary
"My phone lost signal and money is going from my account"	Financial fraud	Account, SIM or device takeover
"Someone made a fake profile of my daughter (15) and is messaging boys"	Child safety	Impersonation and false content
"A loan app is sending my photos to my contacts"	Harassment and extortion	Financial fraud (if money was taken)
"The school computer shows a ransom message"	Malware and ransomware	Child safety (children's records)
"A voice that sounds like my son asked for money; I paid"	Financial fraud	Impersonation (voice clone)

Remember

Choose the most harmful category as primary. One incident can need several routes at once.

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TOPIC 4 · THE FOUR-COLOUR URGENCY SCALE

7 minutes · RED · AMBER · YELLOW · GREEN · justifying a colour · re-grading when facts change

What is it?

The urgency colour tells everyone how fast to act and what to do first. It is decided by **present danger, active loss and spread**. A colour is always written with a **reason** ("AMBER: second debit during intake; possible SIM takeover"). When a material fact changes, the colour is **re-graded** and the new reason recorded.

The four-colour urgency scale

Grade by present danger, active loss and spread — not by the size of the loss

RED	Risk to life, serious distress, child in danger, coercive live threat	112 and stay with the person; child: 1098 and police	NOW
AMBER	Active loss, account or SIM takeover, remote access, spreading malware	1930 and bank; isolate device; telecom or IT lead	NOW
YELLOW	No immediate danger or active compromise; past loss or abuse	NCRP and bank or platform; preserve; review	Same day
GREEN	Suspicious message only; no loss, exposure or compromise	Chakshu for calls and SMS; safety advice	Promptly

Colours are local action targets, not legal deadlines. Danger overrides every other colour.

Figure 4.6 · The four-colour urgency scale

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Figure 4.7 · Re-grade whenever a material fact changes

New fact during the intake	Typical re-grade	Why
A new debit appears	YELLOW → AMBER	Loss is now active
Threat to share intimate images, or talk of self-harm	Any → RED	Risk to safety overrides everything
A child is involved in sexual exploitation	Any → RED	Safeguarding: police and 1098 now
Ransomware reaches other computers on the network	AMBER (stays), escalate to IT lead	Spreading organisational harm
Bank confirms card and UPI blocked; no new activity	AMBER → YELLOW	Active loss stopped; complaint the same day

Golden rules of grading

- Never wait for a complete form before calling for help in a RED or AMBER case.
- An old case with a new threat is urgent.
- If you are unsure between two colours, choose the higher one and tell the mentor.

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TOPIC 5 · STABILISE SAFELY

4 minutes · stop active harm · clean device · airplane mode · what never to do

What is it?

Stabilising means stopping the harm from getting worse while keeping evidence intact. Most stabilising actions are simple: end the call, stop payments, call the bank from a clean phone, cut the network connection of a device that may be controlled remotely. The mistakes that destroy evidence — resetting, uninstalling, deleting chats — are also the ones frightened people try first.



Figure 4.8 · Stabilise safely: Stop, Save, Report

Situation	Stabilising action	Never
Scam call in progress	End the call; no more payments	Stay on the line “to find out more”
Remote-access app suspected	Airplane mode; Wi-Fi and Bluetooth off; use another phone for the bank	Uninstall the app or factory-reset first
Active debits	Bank helpline from the card number; 1930	Wait for the bank to call back
SIM suddenly dead	Call the telecom provider from another phone; alert the bank	Buy a new SIM later and ignore it
Ransom note on a PC	Unplug the network cable; inform the IT lead; photograph the screen	Pay, decrypt or power off repeatedly

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TOPIC 6 · RECORDS, CONSENT AND HAND-OVER

2 minutes · the eight-field record · ownership · confirming the hand-over

What is it?

A case is not finished when the citizen leaves; it is finished when the right agency has **accepted** it and the next check is scheduled. The record is short, factual and time-ordered, and it never contains secrets. Keep the citizen's identity off shared groups and dashboards.



Figure 4.9 · A one-page record anyone can act on

KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM MODULE 4

Takeaway	In one line
Danger first	Present danger, active loss and spread decide urgency — not the amount
Six questions	What, when, still active, who or what, safety, already done
Facts apart from guesses	Observed fact · citizen's account · working hypothesis
Colour plus reason	And re-grade when a material fact changes
Stabilise without destroying	No reset, uninstall or deletion
Own the hand-over	Receiver, reference and next check recorded

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